Apoti Development Association (ADA)

Annual Report 2023

"Fewer Projects. Deeper Impact. Wider Reach."

Organization	Apoti Development Association (ADA)
Registration	N° 415/G.37/D14/VolI/SAAJP
Year	January – December 2023
Headquarters	Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Website	apotidev.org
Motto	Love, Respect & Service (1 John 4:8)

Message from the Founder

Dear friends and partners,

2023 was a defining year for ADA — not because we did more, but because we chose to do *fewer things better*.

After an ambitious 2022 with seven projects across two cities, we made a deliberate strategic decision: consolidate our strengths, deepen our impact, and expand only where we could sustain quality. The result was four carefully chosen initiatives that delivered measurable, lasting change in the lives of 242 people across three cities.

This year marked two significant firsts. We launched our first long-term program in Yaoundé — a six-month vocational training for young women in Cameroon's capital. And we brought our back-to-school initiative to Bamenda for the first time, partnering with four local schools to support 20 orphaned children. Both represent ADA's evolution from a reactive organization to one that plans strategically and invests for sustained outcomes.

The numbers tell a story of stewardship: we delivered all four projects 3.4% under budget while maintaining — and in many cases exceeding — our impact targets. Eight of ten women in our skills training are now earning income. Two have opened their own businesses. Every sponsored child in Bamenda remained in school through the end of the year.

ADA is no longer a startup finding its footing. We are an established organization making deliberate choices about where to invest our limited resources for maximum kingdom impact. We are learning that depth matters more than breadth, and that sustainable growth requires the discipline to say "not yet" to good opportunities so we can say "yes" to the right ones.

Thank you for walking this journey with us. Your prayers, partnership, and generosity make this work possible.

In service,

Lionel Tchami Nfada, MSc Founder & President Apoti Development Association

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About ADA

Who We Are

Apoti Development Association (ADA) is a faith-based non-profit organization registered in Cameroon, dedicated to empowering vulnerable communities through practical programs rooted in the love of Christ.

Our Mission

To shine the light of Jesus Christ by empowering vulnerable communities — widows, orphans, and young women — through programs that restore dignity, build capacity, and create pathways to self-sufficiency.

Our Values

- **Love** — Every program begins with genuine care for the whole person
- **Respect** — We honour the dignity and agency of those we serve
- **Service** — We lead by serving, following Christ's example

Where We Work (2023)

ADA now operates across **3 regions** and **3 cities** in Cameroon:

City	Region	Role	Since
Buea	South-West	Headquarters	2021
Bamenda	North-West	Regional Office	2022
Yaoundé	Centre	Program City	2023

Who We Serve

- **Widows** — Emotional support, material provision, community connection
- **Orphans** — Education sponsorship, school supplies, mentorship
- **Young Women** — Vocational training, business skills, economic empowerment
- **Communities** — Environmental stewardship, civic engagement

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2023 at a Glance

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│                  2023 KEY METRICS                    │
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│                                                      │
│   4 Projects        242 Beneficiaries                │
│   3 Cities          3 Regions                        │
│   $4,600 Budget     $4,442 Spent                     │
│   $158 Saved        3.4% Under Budget                │
│                                                      │
│   ──────────────────────────────────────────────     │
│                                                      │
│   10 Women Trained    8 Earning Income               │
│   2 Businesses Opened                                │
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│   20 Children Sponsored                                │
│   100% School Retention Rate                           │
│   4 School Partnerships                                │
│   12 Widows Visited                                    │
│   200 Community Members Reached                        │
│                                                         |
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Year in Review — Project Summaries

1. Women's Day Home Visits

March 8, 2023 | Buea | Budget: $600 | Actual: $575 (345,000 CFA)

On International Women's Day, ADA volunteers conducted door-to-door visits to 12 widows in Buea. Rather than hosting a large public event, we chose an intimate, dignity-centred approach — meeting each woman in her own home with gifts, prayer, and genuine conversation.

Each visit included provision of essential household items, personal care packages, and extended time for fellowship. This model reflects ADA's belief that true empowerment begins with being seen and valued as an individual, not as a number in a crowd. The home visit format allowed our team to assess each widow's specific needs and connect them with ongoing community support networks.

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2. Young Women Skills Training

April – October 2023 | Yaoundé | Budget: $2,000 | Actual: $1,917 (1,150,000 CFA)

ADA's flagship program of 2023 — and our first initiative in Cameroon's capital city. Ten young women from vulnerable backgrounds enrolled in a six-month vocational training program covering hairdressing, tailoring, and small business management.

This was ADA's second vocational training cohort and our most successful to date. By program completion, 8 of 10 participants were earning independent income, and 2 had opened their own small businesses. The program included not only technical skills but also financial literacy, customer service, and business planning — equipping graduates for long-term economic independence rather than short-term employment. Launching in Yaoundé demonstrated ADA's capacity to replicate proven models in new geographic contexts.

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3. City Cleanup — Labour Day

May 1, 2023 | Buea | Budget: $400 | Actual: $383 (230,000 CFA)

For the third consecutive year, ADA organized a community cleanup on Labour Day, mobilizing volunteers to clean public spaces, clear drainage channels, and promote environmental stewardship in Buea. An estimated 200 community members benefited indirectly from improved sanitation and public spaces.

This annual tradition has become a signature ADA event — a visible demonstration that faith-based organizations contribute to civic life beyond spiritual programs. The cleanup also serves as a community engagement and volunteer recruitment opportunity, introducing new people to ADA's broader mission.

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4. Back-to-School Drive 2023

August – December 2023 | Bamenda | Budget: $1,600 | Actual: $1,567 (940,000 CFA)

ADA's first back-to-school initiative in Bamenda supported 20 orphaned children with school fees, uniforms, books, and supplies across 4 partner schools in the North-West Region. This expansion from Buea to Bamenda was strategic — the anglophone crisis has left many children in the North-West without parental support or educational access.

The program achieved a 100% school retention rate through December, with every sponsored child remaining enrolled and attending classes. ADA's partnership model — working directly with school administrators for accountability — proved effective in a new city context. Monthly check-ins ensured children were attending, performing, and receiving adequate support.

Financial Summary

Overview

Metric	Amount
Total Income (Donations)	$4,600
Total Expenditure	$4,442
Savings (Under Budget)	$158
Budget Efficiency	96.6% spent

Expenditure by Project

Project	Budget	Actual	Variance	% of Total
Women's Day Home Visits	$600	$575	-$25	13%
Young Women Skills Training	$2,000	$1,917	-$83	43%
City Cleanup — Labour Day	$400	$383	-$17	9%
Back-to-School Drive 2023	$1,600	$1,567	-$33	35%
TOTAL	**$4,600**	**$4,442**	**-$158**	**100%**

Expenditure by Category

Category	Amount	% of Total
Education & School Supplies	$1,567	35%
Vocational Training & Materials	$1,917	43%
Widow Support & Provisions	$575	13%
Community & Environmental	$383	9%
TOTAL	**$4,442**	**100%**

Financial Notes

- All projects delivered under budget with no quality compromise

- 0% administrative overhead charged to project budgets (admin costs covered separately)
- Exchange rate used: 1 USD ≈ 600 CFA
- All expenditures documented with receipts and verified by Country Director

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Impact by Demographic

Widows (12 beneficiaries)

- 12 widows received personalized home visits
- Material support including household essentials and personal care items
- Emotional and spiritual support through one-on-one fellowship
- Connected to ongoing community support networks

Young Women (10 beneficiaries)

- 10 young women completed 6-month vocational training
- 8 of 10 (80%) earning independent income post-program
- 2 of 10 (20%) opened their own businesses
- Skills acquired: hairdressing, tailoring, business management, financial literacy
- Average age: 18–25 years

Orphans (20 beneficiaries)

- 20 children received full school sponsorship
- 100% school retention rate (all 20 remained enrolled through December)
- Support included: fees, uniforms, books, supplies
- 4 school partnerships established in Bamenda
- Monthly monitoring and check-ins conducted

Community (200 indirect beneficiaries)

- Improved public sanitation in Buea neighbourhoods
- Cleared drainage channels reducing flood risk
- Volunteer engagement and civic participation modelled
- Environmental stewardship awareness raised

Geographic Expansion

ADA's Growth Trajectory

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2021        2022              2023
 |           |                 |
 ▼           ▼                 ▼
BUEA ──→ BUEA + BAMENDA ──→ BUEA + BAMENDA + YAOUNDÉ
(SW)     (SW)   (NW)        (SW)   (NW)      (Centre)

1 city    2 cities           3 cities
1 region  2 regions          3 regions
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City Profiles

Buea (HQ) — South-West Region

- ADA headquarters since 2021
- Programs: Women's Day, Labour Day Cleanup
- Role: Administrative hub, community programs

Bamenda — North-West Region

- Office established 2022
- Programs: Back-to-School Drive
- Role: Education sponsorship, crisis-affected communities

Yaoundé — Centre Region *(NEW 2023)*

- First program launched April 2023
- Programs: Young Women Skills Training
- Role: Vocational training, economic empowerment

Expansion Strategy

ADA's geographic growth follows a deliberate model:

1. **Pilot** — Test a proven program model in the new city
2. **Partner** — Identify local institutions and community leaders
3. **Sustain** — Only expand further once current programs are self-sustaining
4. **Replicate** — Adapt successful models to local context

Governance & Team

Board of Directors

Role	Name
Founder & President	Lionel Tchami Nfada, MSc
Country Director	Naomi Ndababonga

Organizational Structure

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Founder & President (International)
        │
        ▼
Country Director (Buea)
        │
        ├── Buea Programs
        ├── Bamenda Programs
        └── Yaoundé Programs
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Governance Principles

- Transparent financial reporting with receipt documentation
- Dual oversight: international leadership + local management
- Project-based budgeting with pre-approval requirements
- Regular reporting to donors and stakeholders
- Annual review and strategic planning cycle

Challenges & Lessons Learned

Challenges

Multi-city logistics Operating across three cities in three regions introduced coordination complexity. Travel between Buea, Bamenda, and Yaoundé requires significant time and cost, and communication across distances demands more structured reporting systems.

Anglophone crisis impact The ongoing socio-political situation in the North-West and South-West regions continues to affect program delivery, particularly in Bamenda. School closures, movement restrictions, and community displacement remain real operational risks.

Scaling with limited staff With a lean team, expanding to a third city stretched our human capacity. Each new location requires local relationships, oversight, and accountability structures that take time to build.

Lessons Learned

Depth over breadth delivers better outcomes Reducing from 7 projects (2022) to 4 projects (2023) allowed us to invest more time, resources, and attention in each initiative. The result: higher completion rates, better follow-up, and more measurable impact.

Long-term programs create lasting change The 6-month skills training in Yaoundé produced dramatically better outcomes than shorter interventions. Sustained engagement allows for skill mastery, relationship building, and genuine transformation.

Local partnerships are essential for expansion Our success in Bamenda (4 school partnerships, 100% retention) demonstrates that working through established local institutions is more effective than building parallel structures.

Strategic restraint is a strength Saying "no" to good opportunities in order to focus on the right ones is not a limitation — it's a sign of organizational maturity.

Looking Ahead: 2024 Plans

Planned Initiatives

1. Expanded Back-to-School Drive

- Target: 50+ children (up from 20)
- Locations: Bamenda + Buea
- Goal: Establish ADA as a reliable education partner in both cities

2. Young Women's Conference

- First large-scale gathering for young women across all ADA cities
- Focus: Leadership, faith, economic empowerment
- Expected attendance: 100+ participants

3. Emergency Relief Readiness

- Develop rapid-response capacity for crisis situations
- Pre-position relationships with logistics partners
- Create emergency fund reserve

4. Continued Vocational Training

- Third cohort planned (location TBD)
- Curriculum refinement based on 2023 learnings
- Alumni mentorship network development

Strategic Priorities for 2024

1. **Strengthen existing programs** before adding new ones
2. **Build local teams** in Bamenda and Yaoundé
3. **Develop sustainable funding** beyond individual donations
4. **Improve monitoring & evaluation** systems
5. **Document and share** our models for replication

How to Support Us

Give

Your financial partnership directly funds programs that transform lives. ADA operates with minimal overhead — your donation goes to the field.

- **One-time gifts** — Support a specific project or general operations
- **Monthly giving** — Provide predictable funding for sustained programs
- **Sponsor a child** — Cover school fees, supplies, and monitoring for one year

Pray

- For the widows, orphans, and young women we serve
- For wisdom in strategic decisions and expansion
- For safety of our team operating in crisis-affected regions
- For sustainable funding and new partnerships

Partner

- **Churches** — Host an ADA awareness event or fundraiser
- **Businesses** — Sponsor a project or provide in-kind support
- **Schools** — Partner for education sponsorship programs
- **Individuals** — Volunteer skills (design, writing, tech, training)

Spread the Word

- Share our story on social media
- Connect us with potential donors and partners
- Invite us to speak at your church, school, or organization

Contact & Legal Information

Contact

Email	info@apotidev.org
Phone/WhatsApp	+237 676 282 346
Website	apotidev.org

Office Locations

Headquarters Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon

Regional Office Bamenda, North-West Region, Cameroon

Legal Registration

Full Name	Apoti Development Association
Abbreviation	ADA
Registration Number	N° 415/G.37/D14/VolI/SAAJP
Type	Non-Profit Association
Jurisdiction	Republic of Cameroon

"Beloved, let us love one another, for love is from God, and whoever loves has been born of God and knows God." — 1 John 4:7

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This report covers the period January 1 – December 31, 2023.